

Dr Awasthi lauded the support of the IFFCO team stating, "By incorporating nanotechnology, drone technology, AI technologies we are transforming the agriculture and food value chain of the country. This is possible due to the commitment and hard work of IFFCO's Scientists, Engineers, Sales/Marketing teams at plants and various offices across the country."

Advance technology is indeed a boon to the agriculture sector, which has significantly helped to enhance efficiency, productivity and sustainability through innovations ultimately improving food security and farmer livelihoods. Self-sufficiency in fertiliser production is essential for achieving self-sufficiency in food grain production because fertiliser are crucial inputs for increasing productivity. Nanotechnology has the potential of playing a decisive role in achieving maximum efficiency using minimum input in agriculture. Nanotechnology is applicable to spectrum of farming needs ranging from crop nutrition, crop care, post-harvest interventions etc. IFFCO Nanoventions is involved in developing nanoformulations in agriculture with optimum use efficiency and the principle is to enhance the entry, translocation and assimilation of active ingredients in the plant system through nanotechnological interventions. The company has multiple process and design patents in nanotechnology and it is constantly pursuing to promote green and precision farming. Biotic and abiotic stressors that are further complicated by climate change pose a huge challenge in agriculture. "By understanding the dynamics of the complex agro eco system, we are working to evolve solutions and formulations that are affordable to farmers and sustainable to environment," says Dr.Lakshmanan.

IFFCO has sold more than 85 million 500 ml bottles of Nano Urea and over 11 million bottles of Nano DAP, resulting in huge savings of conventional soil applied Urea and DAP. This has led to enhanced productivity, soil fertility and environmental health. "IFFCO also exports these Nano products namely Nano Urea & Nano DAP to more than 25 countries like the USA, Brazil, Denmark & several African nations. This sales data



confirms the field efficiency and wide acceptability of Nano fertiliser across multiple stakeholders in India and across the world," says Mr.Yogendra Kumar, Marketing Director at IFFCO.

Today, Dr. Awasthi's admirable contributions have not only transformed farming practices but also inspired a new generation of scientists and innovators to explore the potentials of nano technology in addressing the

global food and nutritional security and more importantly in achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG). IFFCO continues to walk on the footsteps of Dr Awasthi's unparalleled dedication in integrating cutting-edge technology with traditional farming wisdom to ensure India's food security and famers' welfare. IFFCO wishes the octogenarian a happy and healthy life ahead and his continued guidance and patronage.

